

India's gig economy set to boom: Navigating the future of work

According to TeamLease, **employment** in India's gig economy **is** set to double in the next five years. This form of work **differs** from traditional employment due to factors that make it difficult to ensure labour rights. **Regulating** the platform worker market **requires** a **nuanced** approach, one that avoids introducing **rigidities**, while remaining **inclusive**. Rules must be **tailored** to **address mobility**, working conditions, **social security** and **bargaining power**. Gig work must be classified as employment, followed by conditions that define it. India has taken the first step by **incorporating** platform work into a separate labour **code**, and introduced measures to expand publicly funded social security for gig workers. This year's budget announced that GoI will provide healthcare benefits for gig workers under PM Jan Arogya Yojana. Private companies must follow for their own benefit.

This approach avoids the **pitfalls** of classifying gig work strictly as employment, which could **hinder** the growth of **ecommerce**, or as self-employment, which would **limit** access to **formalised** social security. Future **interventions** must **account for** the **fluid nature** of the gig economy. These include access to credit that considers income fluctuations, **portability** of social security due to the temporary nature of engagements, skilling for upward mobility, ensuring **algorithms** do not **alter** contract conditions without human **oversight**, and maintaining **pay parity** with wages in formal employment.



Access to insurance is critical. Gig work often involves navigating busy and **inconsistently** regulated transportation infra. This challenge becomes even more **pressing** as the sector expands beyond large urban centres. Policy must also address the likely imbalance in bargaining power resulting from use of AI. Another critical factor is skilling. Without opportunities for growth, **supply** of labour for **dead-end jobs** **may dwindle**. Tech **dispersion** creates more pathways for individual advancement. The platform economy **competes** with traditional distribution channels and must **cultivate** its own **talent pool**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

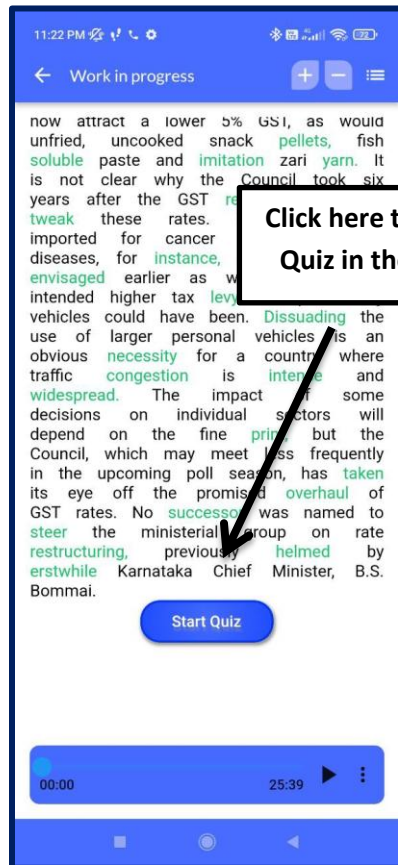
1. **Gig economy** (noun) – a free market system in which temporary positions are common and organizations hire independent workers for short-term commitments
2. **Set** (to) (verb) – Prepare, Plan, Aim, Intend, Target तैयार होना
3. **Boom** (verb) – Thrive, Flourish, Expand, Surge, Grow तेजी से बढ़ना
4. **Navigate** (verb) – Steer, Manage, Guide, Direct, Handle मार्गदर्शन करना
5. **Differ** (verb) – Vary, Contrast, Deviate, Diverge, Disagree अलग होना
6. **Nuanced** (adjective) – Subtle, Refined, Detailed, Complex, Layered सूक्ष्म
7. **Rigidity** (noun) – Inflexibility, Stiffness, Strictness, Rigor, Firmness कठोरता
8. **Inclusive** (adjective) – Comprehensive, All-embracing, Broad, Wide-ranging, Universal समावेशी
9. **Tailor** (verb) – Customize, Adapt, Modify, Shape, Adjust अनुकूल बनाना
10. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, Handle, Resolve, Confront, Manage सुलझाना
11. **Mobility** (noun) – Movement, Flexibility, Portability, Transition, Shift गतिशीलता
12. **Social security** (noun) – monetary assistance from the state for people with an inadequate or no income. सामाजिक सुरक्षा
13. **Bargaining power** (noun) – the ability of a party to influence others in a negotiation to get a favorable outcome
14. **Incorporate** (verb) – Include, Integrate, Absorb, Embed, Combine शामिल करना
15. **Code** (noun) – Regulation, Law, Statute, Guideline, Framework नियम
16. **Pitfall** (noun) – Trap, Hazard, Risk, Snag, Drawback खतरा
17. **Hinder** (verb) – Obstruct, Impede, Hamper, Block, Delay रोकना
18. **Ecommerce** (noun) – the act of buying or selling goods and services over the internet.
19. **Limit** (verb) – Restrict, Constrain, Cap, Curb, Confine सीमित करना
20. **Formalised** (adjective) – Standardized, Structured, Organized, Systematized, Official औपचारिक
21. **Intervention** (noun) – Involvement, Mediation, Interference, Action, Step हस्तक्षेप

22. **Account for** (phrasal verb) – Comprise, make up, total, represent, constitute
बनाना
23. **Fluid nature** (noun) – Flexibility, Adaptability, Changeability, Dynamism, Variability लचीली प्रकृति
24. **Portability** (noun) – Transferability, Mobility, Movability, Flexibility, Adaptability सुवाह्यता
25. **Algorithm** (noun) – Formula, Process, Procedure, Mechanism, Protocol
एल्गोरिदम
26. **Alter** (verb) – Change, Modify, Adjust, Adapt, Transform बदलना
27. **Oversight** (noun) – Supervision, Monitoring, Control, Management, Surveillance निगरानी
28. **Pay parity** (noun) – Wage equality, Equal pay, Salary equity, Compensation balance, Income fairness वेतन समानता
29. **Inconsistently** (adverb) – Erratically, Unevenly, Irregularly, Sporadically, Unpredictably असंगत रूप से
30. **Pressing** (adjective) – Urgent, Critical, Immediate, Acute, Compelling जरूरी
31. **Dead-end job** (noun) – Stagnant work, Unpromising role, Limited opportunity, Routine task, Low-growth position बिना भविष्य वाली नौकरी
32. **Dwindle** (verb) – Diminish, Decline, Shrink, Reduce, Decrease कम होना
33. **Dispersion** (noun) – Spread, Distribution, Scattering, Diffusion, Dissemination फैलाव
34. **Compete** (with) (verb) – Rival, Contest, Vie, Challenge, Oppose प्रतिस्पर्धा करना
35. **Cultivate** (verb) – Nurture, Develop, Foster, Promote, Encourage विकसित करना
36. **Talent pool** (noun) – a group of people with skills that may be available for a job प्रतिभा भंडार

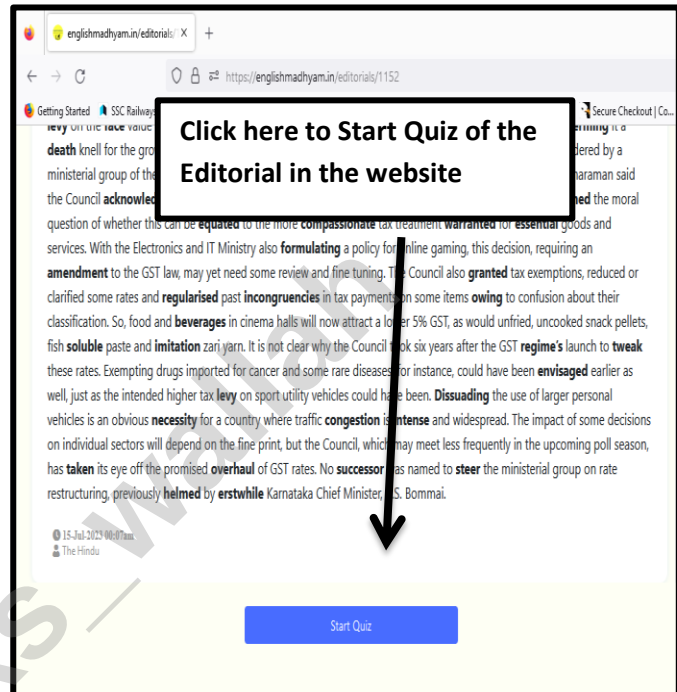
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Gig Economy Growth Projection** – Employment in India's gig economy is expected to double within the next five years.
2. **Challenges in Labour Rights Protection** – The gig economy lacks traditional employment structures, making labour rights enforcement complex.
3. **Need for Flexible yet Inclusive Regulation** – Regulations must balance worker protections without introducing rigidities that stifle growth.
4. **Classification of Gig Work** – Defining gig work as employment is essential to establish appropriate working conditions.
5. **Labour Code for Platform Work** – India has included platform work in a separate labour code to ensure better oversight.
6. **Social Security Expansion for Gig Workers** – The government has introduced measures to expand publicly funded social security benefits.
7. **Healthcare Benefits in Budget 2025-26** – Gig workers will now receive healthcare benefits under the PM Jan Arogya Yojana.
8. **Private Sector Role** – Companies should adopt similar measures to provide social protections for their gig workforce.
9. **Avoiding Overly Rigid Classification** – Classifying gig work strictly as employment could harm e-commerce, while self-employment limits access to social security.
10. **Accounting for Gig Work Fluidity** – Policies must consider fluctuating incomes, social security portability, and temporary engagements.
11. **Importance of Insurance** – Gig workers face risks due to inconsistent transportation infrastructure, making insurance access crucial.
12. **Impact of AI on Bargaining Power** – AI-driven contract decisions could create power imbalances that require regulatory oversight.
13. **Skilling for Career Progression** – Providing skill development opportunities can prevent stagnation in low-paying gig jobs.
14. **Technology as a Growth Enabler** – Wider tech adoption can create more opportunities for individual career advancement.
15. **Gig Economy vs Traditional Sectors** – The platform economy competes with conventional distribution channels and must develop its own skilled workforce.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



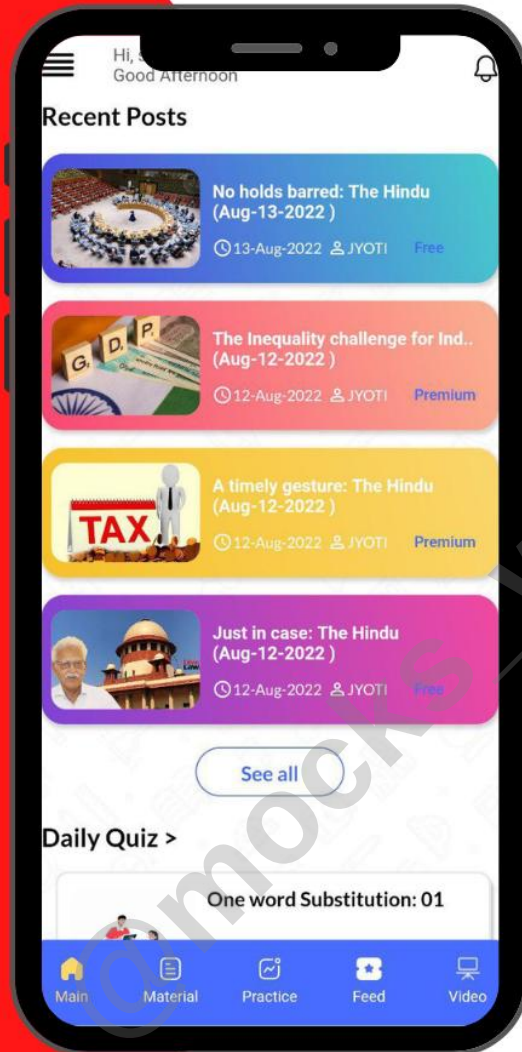
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